



TRIENNIAL
INTERNATIONAL
COMMUNITY
CONFERENCES
2026

Volume I | Issue VIII | 19 August 2026

Conference Date: 19-21 November 2026 |
CHRIST University, Bangalore, India

*"The place God calls you to is the place where your deep gladness
and the world's deep hunger meet." — Frederick Buechner,
Wishful Thinking (1973)*

The Cobbler's Last

Where Every Craft Finds Its Feet - TICC'26

There's an old proverb, worn smooth from use: **The cobbler's children go barefoot.** The one who spends all day fitting leather to strangers' feet somehow never turns that skill homeward. At the centre of his trade sits a last, a wooden form shaped like a foot, over which every shoe is built. Not the shoe itself, but the shape the shoe remembers; invisible once the leather is gone, indispensable to everything that came before it. Buechner asks for a meeting, gladness and hunger crossing paths, but meetings assume proximity, and proximity isn't guaranteed by skill alone. A lighthouse throws its beam for miles and leaves the rocks beneath it dark.

Every step leaves a trace, but only if a shoe was ever made to take it. The last doesn't walk; it only holds the shape of a walking not yet done, waiting for someone to notice the gap between what they're gifted at and who stands, unnoticed, just close enough to touch. Perhaps that's the quieter reading of the quote: not **go find** where gladness meets the world's hunger, but **look down**, check whether it already has, in the hunger too familiar to count as a calling.

The last remembers every foot it was shaped for. What's worth asking is whose foot you've been shaping toward all along, and whose you've left standing, still bare, just behind you. TICC 26 gathers a great many lasts in one room, different hands, different crafts, all shaped by feet they've spent years learning. What the conference offers isn't a new calling to chase, but a chance to compare shapes: to see, side by side, whose gladness was quietly built for whose hunger all along, and to walk out, finally, in the shoes that were always waiting.

Kintsugi, in Reverse

Every Vessel Carries Its Gold Differently

Everyone knows Kintsugi, the art of mending broken pottery with gold, making the fracture part of the object's story rather than something to hide. What's spoken of less is the assumption buried inside it: that the piece was whole once, that the gold only arrives after something has already shattered. But some seams are laid down long before any break. Not repair work, preparation. The quiet, unglamorous acts of gladness that reinforce a person in advance, gold poured into a vessel that hasn't cracked yet and may never crack in a way anyone sees. Buechner's hunger doesn't always arrive as catastrophe. Sometimes it arrives as a hairline stress, and what meets it isn't a dramatic mending but a seam that was already there, waiting, put in place by someone who never expected to need it.

Every step leaves a trace, and not all traces mark a wound. Some mark a reinforcement, gold laid in the grain long before pressure finds it, invisible until the moment it's tested. TICC 26 gathers a great many vessels reinforced this way, people carrying seams no one else could see, poured in quietly over months of showing up for hungers too small to name as calling. The conference isn't where the breaking happens. It's where the pre-laid gold finally catches the light, seam after seam, and for a few days a room full of quietly reinforced people gets to see, together, what all that invisible mending was actually for.

Keynote Speakers

Day 1: Education



Dr. Jim Henderson
President, Louisiana Tech
University

The 15th president of Louisiana Tech, Dr. Henderson previously led the University of Louisiana System as its longest-serving president, steering a strategic push toward producing the most educated generation in Louisiana's history. He also served as president of his alma mater, Northwestern State University, where he helped drive the highest enrollment in its 135-year history.

Day 2: Health



Dr. Joseph Hopkins
President, Campbellsville
University

Named president in 2022, Dr. Hopkins brings a background spanning arts leadership, academic administration, and ministry, having served as Dean at Samford University and Converse College, and as worship pastor at churches across five states. A Fulbright Senior Specialist to Indonesia, he carries a rare cross-disciplinary lens into the health conversation.

Day 3: Social



Ms. Marianella Araya Rivera
Head of Lower School,
Westlink International School

An international educator from Costa Rica now based in Hanoi, Vietnam, Marianella's work centers on empowering young people to become agents of peace, sustainability, and social justice, bridging indigenous cultural values with global educational practice.

Podcast - Dr. Pauline Leonard

As the Advisory to Let Us Dream, Dr. Pauline Leonard brings years of grounded experience in guiding the vision behind LUD's work. In this conversation, she reflects on what shaped her own understanding of service, the moments that tested it, and where she sees LUD's role heading as the community around it keeps growing. A candid, unhurried listen for anyone tracing their own path toward purpose.

Tap in to hear the conversation in full.



Watch Now

Change-makers

Call for Nominations - Let Us Dream 2026 Triennial International Community Conference

We invite you to nominate individuals whose contributions in Education, Health, or Social Impact have made a lasting difference within their communities, often without formal recognition.

This year's theme, "Local Wisdom, Global Impact," reflects our conviction that meaningful transformation begins with one person, one community, and one purposeful action.

We encourage you to bring such stories forward for recognition.

Submission Deadline: 30th September, 2026

Nominate Now

"Lights. Camera. Impact." - Short Film Competition 2026

The Let Us Dream Triennial International Conference 2026, in collaboration with the Department of Media Studies, CHRIST (Deemed to be University), invites filmmakers, students, and storytellers to participate in its official Short Film Competition.

Guided by the theme "Local Wisdom, Global Influence," participants are invited to produce short films that celebrate local voices and advance meaningful social impact through visual storytelling. This platform welcomes both emerging and experienced creators seeking international recognition for their work.

Participants are requested to review the Competition Guidelines provided within the registration form.

Submission Deadline: 10th October, 2026

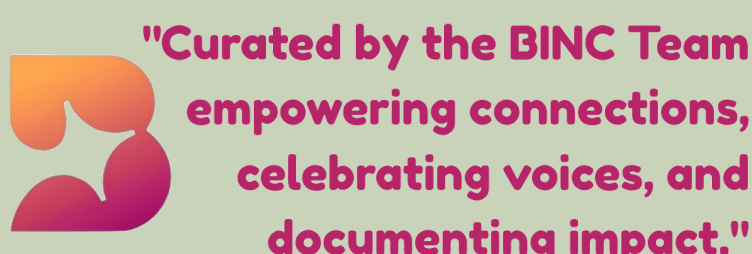
Register Now

We'd Love to Hear From You

We would be glad to hear what resonated with you in this issue, what you would like to see more of, and how we can make future editions more useful and engaging. Your reflections will help the team shape the newsletter with greater care and relevance.

Share Your Feedback

Presented by BINC



Connect with LUD

Follow along for updates, conversations, and upcoming announcements across our platforms.



conference@letusdream.org | +91 99722 22553 | letusdream.org